

ANIME

Demon Slayer 2

★★★★☆ | The second season of Demon Slayer has come to an end with a bang. For a series that has previously been known to break records and set new ones, the new season felt a bit too inconsistent. The second season began with Episodes 2-7 featuring the story from the Mugen Train film. It was meant to help the audience, who missed the movie, to catch up on the events. Although this also meant that the momentum of viewers, who already did watch the movie, took a hit.

The arc follows Tanjiro, Zenitsu, and Inosuke as they travel to Yoshiwara's red-light district with the help of the Sound Hashira Tengen Uzui to hunt down a monster terrorising



the area. The second season begins with Tanjiro and the others donning disguises and undergoing sneaky investigations in order to locate the hidden demon, but the monster is revealed in no time in a scene that has nothing to do with them, depriving them of some potential meaningful

mystery. Moreover, the plot feels like preparation for the series' main fight, which apparently takes place throughout the length of the arc. It's indeed one thrilling moment after another as the fight starts though. Demon Slayer has earned a name for itself with its stunning visual presentation, and the second season is no exception as Ufotable does justice to its hype. But, when you look back on each fight's circumstances, that's basically all there is to it. And because the season lacks a strong emotional anchor, the only option to effectively elevate the stakes is for the characters to be physically abused. At least the balance in character development was better than last time while Tanjiro and Nezuko's relationship still covered a huge part of it. On the other hand, the plot could've been worked upon more to stand up to the fame of the franchise. Overall, the series did feel a bit too short albeit with expected visual and acoustic treats.

—Nayan Panda

TV SHOW

Space Force S2

★★★★☆ | The first season of Steve Carell's new workplace comedy, Space Force, was alright. It was just fun enough for us to be able to sit through the whole thing and we certainly felt it could have been better. We were not expecting a second season, however, after watching season two, we're glad it happened. The show was considerably better, with much better writing and direction this time around.

The premise of the Space Force is that the US has established a Space Force, which is like the Air Force, but for Space. You know, for space supremacy and all that. The second season continues where the first left off, with the team needing to deal with the



repercussions of what happened on the Moon. Which was essentially the Space Force astronauts playing a bunch of pranks on the Chinese astronauts (and vice versa) who also happened to be on the surface of the Moon at the same time. They also almost end up being stranded on the Moon.

Naturally, this was kind of a big deal back on Earth, and it could even

mean the end of the Space Force. The show gains a lot more depth this season, giving more attention to characters and their growth, and exploring the relationships between them. Four Star General Mark Naird, played by Steve Carell, is a lot more toned down this season and there are fewer over the top antics from his character, which we felt took away from him last season. Chief scientist Doctor Mallory, played by John Malkovich, is still a delight to watch, and the season further explores the unlikely developing friendship between him and Naird as they both start to respect each other and the roles they play in Space Force.

Overall, it looks like Space Force season two worked on all the negative feedback it got from the first season, and got some much needed direction. Of course, it also ends on a cliffhanger, which is infuriating, but at least that means there's (hopefully) more coming.

—Manish Rajesh